

Albania



An impoverished, former hardline communist state on the Adriatic struggling to tackle great poverty.

168 BCE The Romans conquer the territory of the Illyrians along the Adriatic coast, which includes present-day Albania.

300s CE Successive waves of invasions of the Balkans precipitate major population movements. The remaining Illyrians seek refuge in the mountains of Albania.

700s Foreign powers (including Byzantium, Bulgaria, Serbia, Epirus, Sicily, and Venice) fight each other for control of Albania. The country is divided into feuding principalities.

1380s Ottoman Turks subject local princes to their rule.

1443–68 Under George Kastrioti, known as Skanderbeg (“Lord Alexander”), the Albanians rebel against Ottoman rule. A Turkish reconquest, completed in 1501, leads to a strong Islamization.

1760 Mehmed Bushati, Pasha of Scutari, throws off Turkish suzerainty. The defeat of his grandson Mustapha in 1831 breaks Bushati power. In the south Ali Pasha of Tepelen establishes an independent state; the Turks overthrow him in 1822.

1878–81 Rebellion first supports the Ottomans by resisting Treaty of Berlin settlement, but then seeks Albanian independence.



Albania's Stalin

Enver Hoxha (1908–85) led the communist resistance to Italian rule and, after 1944, ran Albania on strict Stalinist principles, pursuing a policy of isolation from the rest of the world.

1912 After 40 years of nationalist agitation, Albania asserts its independence from Turkish rule in the First Balkan War (1912–13) and is recognized as a Muslim principality by the 1913 Treaty of London.

1914–18 Albania remains neutral in World War I.

1921 After a long dispute between Italy, Greece, and Yugoslavia, its neighbors recognize the borders established in 1913.

1924 After a rebellion by the landowner Ahmed Zogu, Albania becomes a republic in 1925 with Zogu as president. In 1928 he assumes the title King Zog I.

1939 Italy invades Albania. King Zog flees to England.

1941 Enver Hoxha builds up the Workers' Party as the main, communist resistance movement to Italian rule.

1944 A communist state, led by Enver Hoxha, is established on liberation.

1949 Albania joins the USSR-dominated Comecon trading association.

1955 Founding member of Warsaw Pact communist military alliance.

1956 Hoxha refuses to accept Soviet criticisms of Stalin, and breaks with the USSR, moving toward China.

1961 Albania excluded from Comecon and, in 1968, withdraws from the Warsaw Pact. Foreign travel is banned, and thousands are killed in political purges.

1976 After the death of Mao, Hoxha severs links with China. Albania is now completely isolated from the communist world and from western Europe.

1985 Hoxha dies and is succeeded by his deputy, Ramiz Ali.

1990 Political reforms introduced, but slow progress leads to demonstrations.

1991 In the first multi-party elections since the 1920s, the communists are returned to power, changing their name to the Socialist Party.

1992 The opposition Democratic Party wins elections and Sali Berisha becomes the first non-communist president.

1997 Economic chaos as the failure of a pyramid selling scheme causes revolt. King Zog's son, Leka, fails in bid to become king.

1999 Refugees cross the border from Kosovo.

2007 Former president Berisha of the Democratic Party takes power, ending eight years of Socialist rule.

2009 Albania joins NATO; Democratic Party wins elections by a narrow margin.

«246–47. The Ottoman Empire

Cyprus

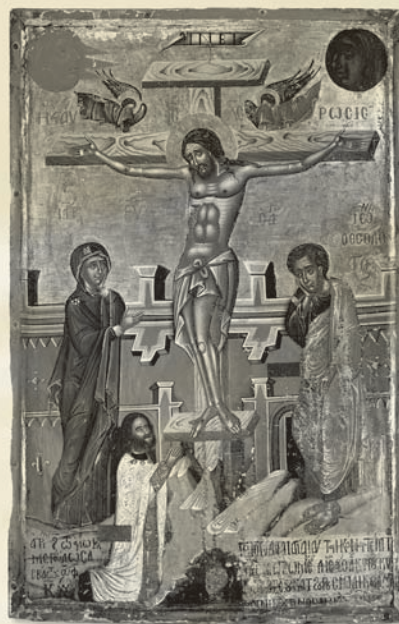


Island in the eastern Mediterranean divided by the Turkish occupation of the north.

333 BCE Alexander the Great's Macedon army captures the island, which in 294 BCE becomes an Egyptian dependency.

58 BCE Cyprus passes into Roman hands.

688 CE Agreement between Byzantium and Muslim Umayyad caliphate leaves island neutral until its reoccupation by Byzantium in 965.



A divided island

Icons such as this one fill Greek Orthodox churches in the southern half of Cyprus. Since 1974, the island has been divided into the Greek south and the Turkish north.

1191–92 Brief English rule under Richard the Lionheart at the end of the Third Crusade. Richard marries Berengaria of Navarre on the island in 1191 and she is crowned Queen of England and Cyprus.

1489 The Venetians annex the island.

1571 The Ottoman conquest marks the start of 300 years of Muslim Turkish rule.

1878 Congress of Berlin: UK takes over the administration of Cyprus under continued Turkish sovereignty.

1914 The UK annexes Cyprus when Turkey joins the Central Powers in World War I.

1923 Greece and Turkey acknowledge British sovereignty over Cyprus under the Treaty of Lausanne.

1925 Island becomes a British Crown Colony.

1931 Greek Cypriot demands for union with Greece culminate in rioting. Direct rule from London is imposed.

1955 The National Organization of Cypriot Fighters (EOKA), Greek Cypriots seeking political unity with Greece (*enosis*), begins a guerrilla war, which lasts until 1959. The Cypriot Nationalist leader is Archbishop Makarios III.

1959 The Zurich and London agreements provide for Cyprus to become independent under a power-sharing agreement between the Greek and Turkish communities, with trilateral guarantees (from Greece, Turkey, and the UK). UK keeps military bases at Akrotiri and Dhekelia. Makarios is elected president in December 1959.

1960 Cyprus gains independence from the UK within the Commonwealth.

1963 Turkish Cypriots abandon parliament in protest at Greek domination. As fighting between the two communities intensifies, the UN sends in troops to keep the peace in 1964.

1974 President Makarios deposed by the Greek military junta in an attempt to enforce *enosis*. Turkey invades to protect the Turkish community, and partitions the island along what becomes the Green Line; 200,000 Greek Cypriots flee the Turkish north, while 65,000 Turkish Cypriots flee in the other direction.

1983 Self-proclamation of the Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus (TRNC) with Rauf Denktash as president, recognized only by Turkey. More than 100,000 mainland Turks now settle in the north.

1991 UN refuses to recognize the TRNC.

1998 Talks on EU membership start, following an application in 1990 to join.

1998 Turkish Cypriot leader Rauf Denktash proposes a federation that recognizes “the equal and sovereign status of Cyprus's Greek and Turkish parts”; the proposal is rejected by both the Greek and Cypriot governments.

2002 UN proposes a peace plan for a common Cypriot state with two component states; the talks collapse in 2003, although the TRNC opens up the Green Line as a goodwill gesture.

2004 In referendums, the UN plan is accepted by Turkish but rejected by Greek Cypriots.

2004 Cyprus joins the EU, but the Turkish north is excluded.

2006 In talks, President Papadopolous and Turkish Cypriot leader Mehmet Ali Talat agree to increased contact.

2007 Greek and Turkish Cypriots demolish barriers dividing the center of Nicosia.

2008 Cyprus adopts the euro. Opposition communist leader Demtris Christofias wins presidential elections.

2010 Pro-independence candidate Dervis Eroglu wins presidential election in TRNC, dealing a blow to reunification talks.